



FREE GUIDE · FOR AMBULATORY SURGERY CENTERS

The Surgery Center's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

High-volume anesthesia controls, sharps, and RMW —
every stream, mail-back or pickup.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Anesthesia controls under the microscope.

Ambulatory surgery centers run high-volume procedures — and with them, controlled anesthetics that the DEA watches closely, plus surgical sharps, red-bag biohazard, and expired medications. Wasted anesthesia doses and the logs behind them are the single most scrutinized area. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor can take your anesthesia controls, sharps, biohazard, and meds — mail-back or scheduled pickup — with non-retrievable destruction, Form 222/41, and a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

High-volume anesthesia controls — fentanyl (Sch II), midazolam, ketamine — plus wasted and partial doses.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V anesthetics
- Wasted & partial anesthesia doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, Form 222 for Schedule II transfers, Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance destruction, to DEA standards.

Tip

Diversion risk makes witnessed wasting logs and a clean paper trail non-negotiable.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Surgical and anesthesia sharps at volume.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Needles, syringes & scalpel blades
- Suture needles
- Anesthesia & procedure sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; high-volume sites should check daily.

WASTE STREAM 03

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Surgical and procedure waste soaked with blood or fluids.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked drapes & gauze
- Contaminated PPE
- Specimen & tissue waste (per state)

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — over-classifying at volume is costly.

WASTE STREAM 04

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired non-controlled medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled Rx
- Non-controlled injectables
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit or pickup.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The surgery center compliance checklist.

- ☐ Anesthesia controls logged, wasted doses witnessed, rendered non-retrievable with Form 41.
- ☐ Surgical sharps in FDA-cleared containers, checked frequently (high volume).
- ☐ Red-bag biohazard labeled, stored securely, and destroyed.

- ☐ Expired non-controlled meds segregated and destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS SURGERY CENTERS ASK

Your surgery center questions, answered.

How do we handle wasted anesthesia controls like fentanyl?

Witness and log every wasted dose, then render it non-retrievable with a DEA Form 41. The wasting log plus a Certificate of Destruction keeps your controlled records audit-ready.

Is propofol a controlled substance?

Propofol isn't federally scheduled, but it's still tracked and wasted like a controlled drug in most ASCs — segregate and document it.

Mail-back or pickup for an ASC?

Either — mail-back for lower volume, scheduled pickup for higher. We'll size it so containers never overfill.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle handles surgery-center waste by prepaid mail-back or scheduled pickup. We destroy every stream at our DEA-registered facility with Form 222/41 handled and a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Anesthesia controls	Controlled destruction (Form 41, wasting logs)
Surgical sharps	Sharps kit or pickup
Biohazard / RMW	Biohazard kit or pickup

Waste stream

The right path

**Expired non-controlled
meds**

Pharmaceutical waste kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Higher-volume ASCs often prefer scheduled pickup over mail-back. We'll size a program — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY SURGERY CENTERS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your surgery center waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop